

Thesis — intent to submit, nominate examiners, catch the Col, schedule the viva

WHAT IT IS

Priya has passed all her milestones. She signals intent to submit. In this chapter we record that intent, nominate two examiners (internal + external), watch the conflict-of-interest check refuse one and accept the other, schedule the viva, record the outcome, track corrections, and land at "award ready". The corrections have their own sub-workflow; the award button only unlocks when they close.

THE CLICKS

01 Record the intent to submit

WHERE Priya's student page → **Thesis** panel → + **Record intent to submit**.

DO Fill: intended submission date (three months out), working title Explainable Reinforcement Learning for Clinical Decision Support.

SEE A thesis row appears with status "Intent recorded". A task appears for the graduate school: "Start examiner nomination for Priya Nair".

SAY ""Student signals intent, and the examiner nomination workflow starts. No one waits for the deadline.""

02 Nominate an internal examiner (that conflicts)

WHERE Same panel → **Examiners** section → + **Nominate internal**.

DO Type Prof. Roland Vega (Priya's former co-supervisor).

SEE Red banner: "Cannot nominate — served as co-supervisor on this thesis."

SAY ""The system knows. Roland was on the record as co-supervisor — he can't examine his own student.""

03 Try a plausible but conflicted external

WHERE Same field, or + **Nominate external**.

DO Type Prof. Jian Kwan (fictional external, has co-authored with Roland).

SEE Amber warning: "Co-authored with Prof. Vega in 2024 — reviewer discretion required." Approve or reject buttons appear.

SAY ""Not disqualifying, but flagged. Prof. Vega's on the record, and Kwan's on a paper with him — worth knowing before the viva.""

04 Nominate a clean external

WHERE Same field.

DO Type Prof. Aisha Adekunle (no prior links). Click **Save nomination**.

SEE Green tick badge. Examiner-invitation workflow task appears in the outbox.

SAY ""Green. Nomination saved. Invitation goes out automatically — no email chain to chase.""

05 Schedule the viva

WHERE Thesis panel → **Viva** section → **Schedule viva**.

DO Fill: date, chair, mode (in-person / hybrid). Save.

SEE Viva row appears with "Scheduled" pill. Calendar invites emit through the outbox.

SAY *“Viva scheduled. Every party gets a calendar invite via the integration outbox — retried if a partner is slow.”*

06 Record the viva outcome

WHERE After the viva (simulate) → **Viva** section → **Record outcome**.

DO Fill: outcome Pass with minor corrections, deadline for corrections (3 months out), notes.

SEE Viva status flips to "Outcome recorded". Corrections sub-workflow opens with state "Not started".

SAY *“Outcome preserved. The corrections sub-workflow opens — the award button stays greyed until they close.”*

THE LINE

“The most compliance-heavy stretch of the arc has the least paperwork — because the state machine does the checking.”